DIGI*WELL*

Digital Well-Being in Higher Education: Unit 4
LONG-TERM PSYCHOLOGICAL WELL-BEING



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TOOLS
Meaningful activities

after Hausler (2022, pp. 119-120)

There are activities that are no fun and that are difficult to motivate yourself for. However, if we recognize the meaning behind them, we can increase our motivation and enjoy a sense of achievement.

Fill in the blank table on the next page with typical activities that you regularly carry out in your digital work. Your list should include pleasant as well as unpleasant activities. Highlight these in different colors: green = pleasant activity, yellow = neutral activity, red = unpleasant activity. Start with the pleasant activities and work your way up to the red ones by asking yourself the following questions:

1. What do I like about the activity, what gives me **pleasure**?
2. What is the **benefit** of the activity, what is the **goal** behind it?
3. What is the **value** of the activity, why is it important to me?

Keep at it with every activity until you come across something that is important to you and makes sense to you. How does this change your perception of this (once unloved) activity?

This exercise promotes awareness of values. Knowing what is important to you helps you to work in a meaningful way. Regularly reflect on the values behind your daily activities. You can also visualize your most important values and put them on a piece of paper as a reminder, for example on your desk, to pay more attention to them.

The following pre-filled table illustrates the exercise using the example of household activities.

Activity	Pleasure	Benefit & Goal	Value
Cooking (green)	Being creative, creating a pleasurable experience, satisfying the family	Healthy nutrition, variation, eating together	Creates health & well-being Promotes family & creativity
Tidying (yellow)	Having a sense of order, leaving a good impression	Cleanliness, feel-good atmosphere, prerequisite for cooking again	Creates health, well-being & order Promotes family & creativity
Mopping (red)	Having a sense of cleanliness, leaving a good impression, living hygienically	Cleanliness, feel-good atmosphere, prerequisite for games on the floor, less dust pollution	Creates health, well-being & order Promotes family

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